

Using Remastersys is quite simple: just add a new software repo to the list (the same old method of adding a new repository by using the Settings – Repositories menu of Synaptic Package Manager) and refresh the package list. Once done, search for it and install it. Although this is simple and worked well for the Ubuntu 10.10 version, we had quite some problems with the new Ubuntu 11.04 Natty Narwhal. The first problem came in when we found that the website did not list out the repository for the new version. When we tried out with the older version, we got what was expected and more: ISOs created with it did not boot, we had kernel panics and non responsive screens, both login screens as well as those completely black in colour. Other remastering software too failed for some reason or the other. It was time we looked into the internals and do it the hard way.

While it is very much recommended that you do not try out the complicated method unless other remastering software fail and you really want to do it, it is always fun to experiment (at your own risk). If you want to remaster Ubuntu, follow the guide at <https://help.ubuntu.com/community/LiveCDCustomization>.

We found a few problems with the guide however. First it is confusing with the various versions' instructions mixed up. Second, since it is not updated for Natty, a few things do not work as expected. One of those was the method to change the live username. While it is mentioned that for version 10.04, we should edit variables in `/etc/casper.conf`, one would think that it should work all the versions released afterwards too. However, that did not happen and we had to change the username by editing the scripts. We present to you the steps in brief:

- ▶ Get the tool needed for customization by running:
 - `sudo aptitude install squashfs-tools genisoimage`
- ▶ If you do not have an internet connection with you, you might use the trick to download the packages offline and install them later on machine.
- ▶ Now create the necessary directories and copy the ISO image file at the appropriate place by running the commands one after another:
 - `mkdir ~/livecdtmp`
 - `mv ubuntu-9.04-desktop-i386.iso ~/livecdtmp`
 - `cd ~/livecdtmp`

Here we are expecting that you have put the ISO image in the home directory.